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Postdocs Rock

THE UCLA POSTDOCTORAL SCHOLARS RECEPTION WAS ESTABLISHED IN 1998 to recognize the important contributions that postdoctoral scholars make to the interrelated missions of research, teaching, and public service at UCLA. At this ceremony, the Chancellor's Award for Postdoctoral Research is conferred on particularly accomplished individuals. The nominees come from virtually every discipline at UCLA, from the basic and applied sciences to the professional schools, the social sciences, and the humanities. This year's ceremony, held on March 22, 2006, honored the work of five outstanding scholars.



Emil Reisler
(Dean of Life Sciences)

Roberto Peccei
(Vice Chancellor
for Research)

Leonard Rome
(Senior Associate
Dean for Research,
David Geffen School
of Medicine)

Claudia Mitchell-Kernan
(Vice Chancellor Graduate
Studies and Dean,
Graduate Division)

Gang Li

Weidong Li

Thomas Cubaud

**Nobel Laureate
Paul Boyer**

Endawoke Yizengaw

Adam Aron



endawoke yizengaw



BORN IN A SMALL VILLAGE OF NORTHWESTERN ETHIOPIA where he once watched over the family's herd of cattle and oxen, today Endawoke Yizengaw tracks the many satellites circling the Earth and studies the structure and dynamics of the surrounding plasma environment. An assistant research professor at UCLA's Institute of Geophysics and Planetary Physics, he also participates in a project coordinated with the Jet Propulsion Laboratory and NASA to improve the accuracy of Global Positioning System (GPS) navigation.

It was his dissertation research on ground-based tomography using GPS-measured data and space-based tomography using GPS receivers on Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellites that earned him international recognition and led to his postdoctoral position at UCLA with Mark Moldwin. Dr. Yizengaw is also interested in studying magnetosphere-ionosphere coupling during severe storm events, which can create power outages, diverted airplanes, knocked out satellites, and interrupted spacecraft communication.

Dr. Yizengaw persevered in pursuing his education despite many obstacles. He had a bachelor's degree in physics and was teaching at Bahir Dar Teachers College (now Bahir Dar University) when a Sunday morning radio broadcast featuring an Ethiopian engineer at JPL/NASA inspired him to pursue a similar career. He earned scholarships to Tromsø University in Norway and then to La Trobe University in Australia.

Dr. Yizengaw is helping to prepare the African Small Instrument Array for the International Heliophysical Year and he recently received the NSF GEM/CEDAR Postdoc Fellowship, in which his proposal was rated No. 1. He looks forward to a career in academic research.